

Journey & Empathy Map Template

Design Thinking — Empathy & Experience Mapping

Context

Persona / User

Rahul the Relocator

Scenario / Goal

Adjusting to a new city while overcoming loneliness, emotional isolation, and rebuilding a support system.

The Timeline

Stage Name Key phase	Stage 1 – Relocation & Isolation	Stage 2 – Struggling to Adjust	Stage 3 – Seeking Connection	Stage 4 – Building Support	Stage 5 – Belonging & Growth
Scene / Event Upload picture					
 Actions What do they do?	Stays in room, avoids social interaction, scrolls social media	Attends classes, watches others interact, explores nearby places	Talks to classmates, joins online groups, attends events	Meets friends regularly, shares feelings, participates in activities	Maintains friendships, helps others, engages in community events
 Touchpoints Channels & Tools	Phone, Instagram, YouTube, old friends online	School, WhatsApp groups, neighborhood, family	Clubs, sports teams, community groups, messaging apps	Friends, counselor, support groups, family discussions	Friend circle, school community, local events, hobbies
 Thoughts Internal mental state	"Nobody understands me." "I miss my old life."	"Maybe I can fit in here." "It's harder than I expected."	"People seem friendly." "I should try talking more."	"I finally have people who listen."	"This place feels like home now."
 Says Key Quotes	"I'm fine." "I just need some time."	"I'm trying to adjust."	"Maybe I'll join that activity."	"It's nice having someone to talk to."	"I'm happier than before."
 Feels Emotions & State	Lonely, restless, emotionally drained	Nervous, uncertain, hopeful	Curious, encouraged, slightly confident	Connected, supported, comfortable	Happy, accepted, confident
Emotion Score -10 to +10					
Experience Curve Automatic Chart					
Pain Points Frictions & Blockers	Emotional isolation, homesickness, missing friends and relationship	Difficulty fitting in, social anxiety, fear of rejection	Overthinking conversations, lack of confidence	Fear of losing new connections, family misunderstanding emotions	Occasional loneliness and adapting to long-term changes
Opportunities Ideas for Improvement	Mental wellness support, online peer groups	School orientation programs, mentorship	Clubs, hobbies, friendship-building activities	Counseling, emotional support groups, family communication	Leadership roles, community involvement, long-term personal growth

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Ananya the Academic

Scenario / Goal

Managing academic pressure while maintaining emotional well-being and meeting family expectations.

The Timeline

Stage Name Key phase	Stage 1 – Academic Pressure Begins	Stage 2 – Comparison & Self-Doubt	Stage 3 – Burnout Phase	Stage 4 – Seeking Support	Stage 5 – Healthy Balance
Scene / Event Upload picture					
👤 Actions What do they do?	Studies for long hours, avoids breaks	Compares marks and achievements	Overworks, skips leisure activities	Shares concerns, asks for advice	Plans schedule, takes breaks
📱 Touchpoints Channels & Tools	School, books, family	Social media, classmates	Assignments, exams, family expectations	Teachers, friends, family	Study planner, support network
💭 Thoughts Internal mental state	"I need to be the best."	"Everyone is doing better than me."	"I can't keep up anymore."	"Maybe I don't have to do this alone."	"I can succeed without exhausting myself."
💬 Says Key Quotes	"I have to study more."	"I'm not good enough."	"I'm tired all the time."	"I need help managing this stress."	"I'm doing my best."
😊 Feels Emotions & State	Motivated, pressured	Anxious, insecure	Burnt out, restless, exhausted	Relieved, hopeful	Confident, balanced, calm
Emotion Score -10 to +10	-4	-1	-6	2	8
Experience Curve Automatic Chart					
Pain Points Frictions & Blockers	Family expectations	Low self-esteem, comparison	Mental exhaustion	Fear of disappointing others	Maintaining consistency
Opportunities Ideas for Improvement	Study skills training	Confidence-building activities	Stress-management programs	Mentorship and counseling	Healthy work-life balance habits

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Rohan the Socialite

Scenario / Goal

Finding genuine relationships and emotional fulfillment beyond social media validation.

The Timeline

Stage Name Key phase	Stage 1 – Social Media Dependency	Stage 2 – Relationship Issues	Stage 3 – Loneliness Behind Popularity	Stage 4 – Self-Reflection	Stage 5 – Authentic Connections
Scene / Event Upload picture					
Actions What do they do?	Posts frequently, seeks validation	Checks messages obsessively	Withdraws emotionally	Focuses on real conversations	Invests in meaningful relationships
Touchpoints Channels & Tools	Instagram, Snapchat, WhatsApp	Partner, friends, social media	Phone, online communities	Trusted friend, counselor	Friends, family, hobbies
Thoughts Internal mental state	"People should notice me."	"Can I trust them?"	"No one truly understands me."	"Maybe social media isn't helping."	"Real connections matter more."
Says Key Quotes	"Did you see my post?"	"Why didn't they reply?"	"I feel alone sometimes."	"I need to focus on myself."	"I feel understood now."
Feels Emotions & State	Excited, validated	Jealous, suspicious	Lonely, disappointed	Reflective, hopeful	Happy, secure, connected
Emotion Score -10 to +10	5	-1	-7	3	9
Experience Curve Automatic Chart					
Pain Points Frictions & Blockers	Dependence on validation	Lack of trust	Emotional loneliness	Breaking unhealthy habits	Maintaining healthy relationships
Opportunities Ideas for Improvement	Digital wellness awareness	Relationship counseling	Emotional support groups	Self-development activities	Community engagement and meaningful social interactions